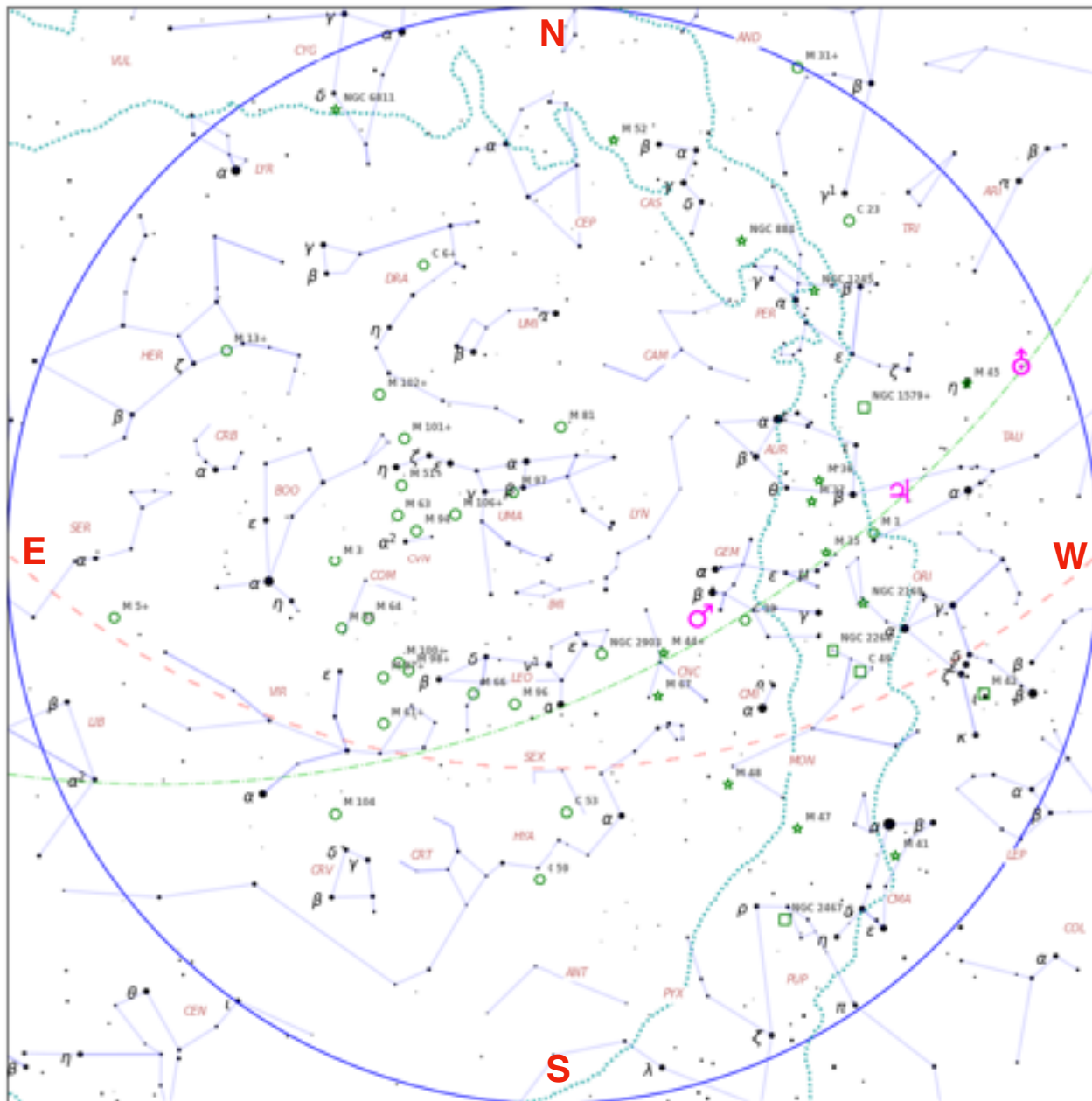


APRIL 2025



The Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Meets the first Wednesday of every month, at the
North Adams Public Library at 6 PM.

74 Church St. North Adams MA

Spring is Here!

Mars and Jupiter shine bright with Jupiter in the West (with Uranus - see last month's newsletter for how to locate is in binoculars) and Mars overhead. The Spring constellations are rising in the East: Leo, Virgo, and Ursa Major.

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Maiden*
 ANT - Antlia - *the Air Pump*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 BOO - Boötes - *the Herdsman*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEN - Centaurus - *the Centaur*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CMA - Canis Major - *the Greater Dog*
 CMI - Canis Minor - *the Lesser Dog*
 CNC - Cancer - *the Crab*
 COL - Columba - *the Dove*
 COM - Coma Berenices - *Berenice's Hair*
 CRB - Corona Borealis - *the Northern Crown*
 CRT - Crater - *the Cup*
 CRV - Corvus - *the Crow*
 CVN - Canes Venatici - *the Hunting Dogs*
 CYG - Cygnus - *the Swan*
 DRA - Draco - *the Dragon*
 GEM - Gemini - *the Twins*
 HER - Hercules - *Hercules*
 HYA - Hydra - *the Water Snake*
 LEO - Leo - *the Lion*
 LEP - Lepus - *the Hare*
 LIB - Libra - *the Scales*
 LMI - Leo Minor - *the Lesser Lion*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 LYR - Lyra - *the Harp*
 MON - Monoceros - *the Unicorn*
 ORI - Orion - *the Hunter*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PUP - Puppis - *the Stern (of Argo)*
 PYX - Pyxis - *the Mariner's Compass*
 SER - Serpens - *the Snake*
 SEX - Sextans - *the Sextant*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*
 VIR - Virgo - *the Maiden*
 VUL - Vulpecula - *the Little Fox*

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right. (Or if you hold the map upside-down and face North, East will be to the right, West to the left.)

On the chart, the orange dashed line shows the celestial Equator; the green dashed-dotted line the Ecliptic. The Milky Way is outlined with a blue dotted line.

Date	Time
Apr 1	10:30 PM (EST)
Apr 8	10:00 PM
Apr 15	9:30 PM
Apr 22	9:00 PM
Apr 29	8:30 PM

Because of the Earth’s motion around the Sun, the time for this chart changes slowly over time, roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Planets

Mercury is in Pisces, visible just before sunrise (in the last half of April).

Venus is in Pisces, visible just before sunrise - rising higher over the course of the month.

Mars in Gemini close to the stars Castor and Pollux, moving into Cancer mid-month.

Jupiter in Taurus - in the West.

Uranus is visible with binoculars or a small telescope W of the Pleiades in Taurus but only just after sunset.